

Q2 FY2026 Brand Equity & Consumer Health Tracker Readout

The Crunchwell relevance slide, the competitive frame, and the 'relevance not trust' thesis

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Period Q2 FY2026 (FY26Q2 wave)

Owner Nina Ortega, Consumer Insights

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Crunchwell Relevance	68.6 → 62.7 (-5.9 pp) — the flag
Crunchwell Trust	72.3 → 72.9 — holds
The thesis	Relevance, not Trust: trusted but drifting from culture
NPS / aided awareness	~6.5 flat · ~82% aware
Social sentiment	ProteinPeak +0.44 vs Crunchwell -0.11

Executive summary

The Q2 equity wave delivers one clear diagnosis for Crunchwell: the problem is relevance, not trust. Crunchwell's Relevance top-two-box has slid from 68.6 to 62.7 (-5.9 pp) across six waves, while Trust holds at ~72, Taste at ~73 and Quality at ~70. The brand is still trusted and still tastes right — it is drifting from cultural relevance. The competitive frame sharpens the point: ProteinPeak (76.2) and Field & Honey (80.9) score far higher on relevance while Crunchwell's trust advantage is being matched. Consumer-health fundamentals (NPS ~6.5, aided awareness ~82%) are flat and healthy — this is not an awareness or quality problem. Social sentiment closes the case: ProteinPeak +0.44, Crunchwell -0.11.

- **The flag:** Crunchwell Relevance 68.6 → 62.7 (-5.9 pp), the only attribute in structural decline.
- **Trust is intact** (72.3 → 72.9) as are Taste (~73) and Quality (~70). Modernity is soft (~49) — the leading edge of the relevance slide.
- **Competitively**, ProteinPeak (76.2 relevance) and Field & Honey (80.9) out-relevance Crunchwell (62.7); the trust moat is narrowing.
- **Fundamentals are flat and fine** — NPS ~6.5, aided awareness ~82%, taste ~3.6/5. The fix is relevance-building, not repair (see the Crunchwell turnaround, Report 24).

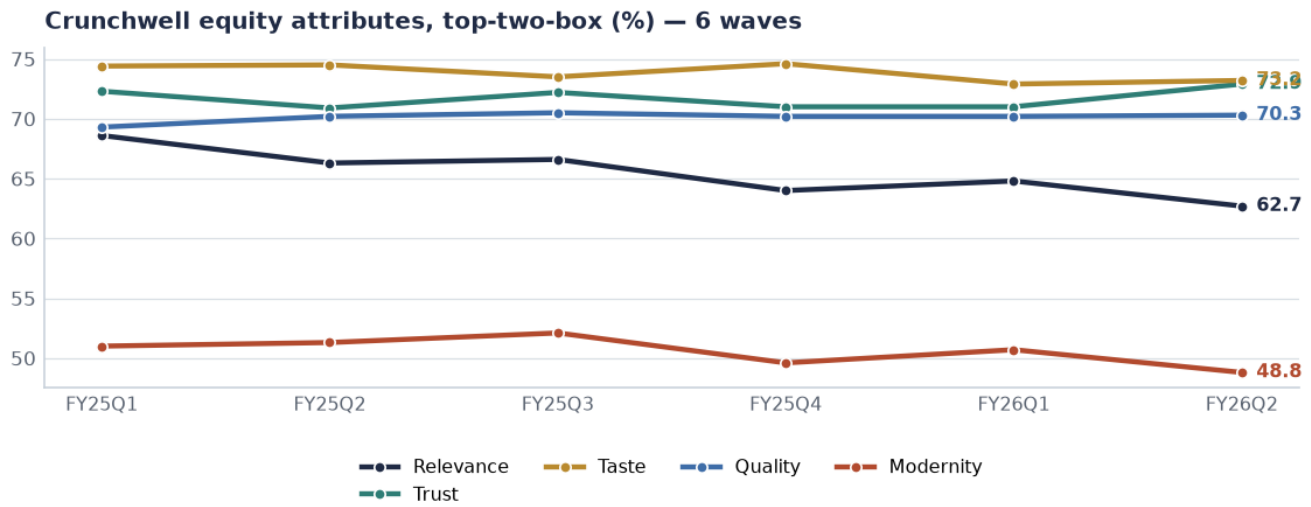
1 · Crunchwell equity scorecard

RELEVANCE	TRUST	NPS	AIDED AWARENESS
62.7	72.9	~6.5	~82%
-5.9 pp / 6 waves	holds	flat	flat

Read the scorecard as a single sentence: everything that says 'do you trust this brand' is stable, and the one thing that says 'is this brand for someone like me, now' is falling. That is a relevance problem, and it is the highest-priority read of the wave.

2 · The relevance slide — six waves

Tracking Crunchwell's five equity attributes across six quarterly waves isolates Relevance as the single moving part. Trust, Taste and Quality run flat-to-up; Modernity is soft and drifting; Relevance is in a clear, sustained decline. Modernity and Relevance moving together is the classic signature of a heritage brand losing cultural currency while its product equity stays intact.

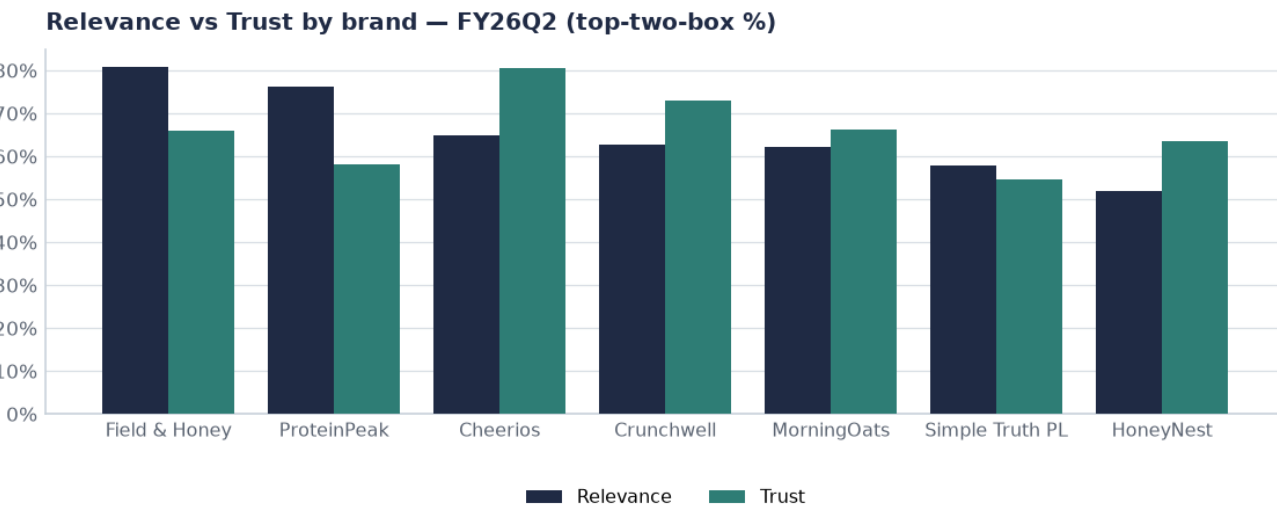


Relevance falls –5.9 pp while Trust, Taste and Quality hold. Modernity drifts down alongside Relevance — the heritage-brand signature.

Source: brand_equity_quarterly, Crunchwell US-NAT, Kantar-shape top-two-box.

3 · Competitive frame — relevance vs trust

Plotting the FY26Q2 wave across the competitive set makes the strategic geometry clear. Crunchwell holds a genuine *trust* advantage over the challenger brands (ProteinPeak 58.1, Field & Honey 66.0) — but is beaten decisively on *relevance* by both ProteinPeak (76.2) and Field & Honey (80.9), and only narrowly leads Cheerios. The established players (Cheerios, Crunchwell) own trust; the insurgents own relevance. Crunchwell's task is to convert its trust equity into contemporary relevance before the trust moat itself erodes.



Crunchwell leads on Trust but trails ProteinPeak and Field & Honey on Relevance. Insurgents own relevance; heritage brands own trust.
Source: brand_equity_quarterly, US-NAT, FY26Q2 wave.

3.1 · Relevance and trust by brand — FY26Q2

Brand	Relevance	Trust	Relevance – Trust
Field & Honey	80.9	66.0	+14.9
ProteinPeak	76.2	58.1	+18.1
Cheerios	65.0	80.5	-15.5
Crunchwell	62.7	72.9	-10.2
MorningOats	62.3	66.3	-4.0
Simple Truth PL	57.9	54.5	+3.4
HoneyNest	51.8	63.5	-11.7

Source: brand_equity_quarterly, US-NAT, FY26Q2.

4 · Consumer health & social sentiment

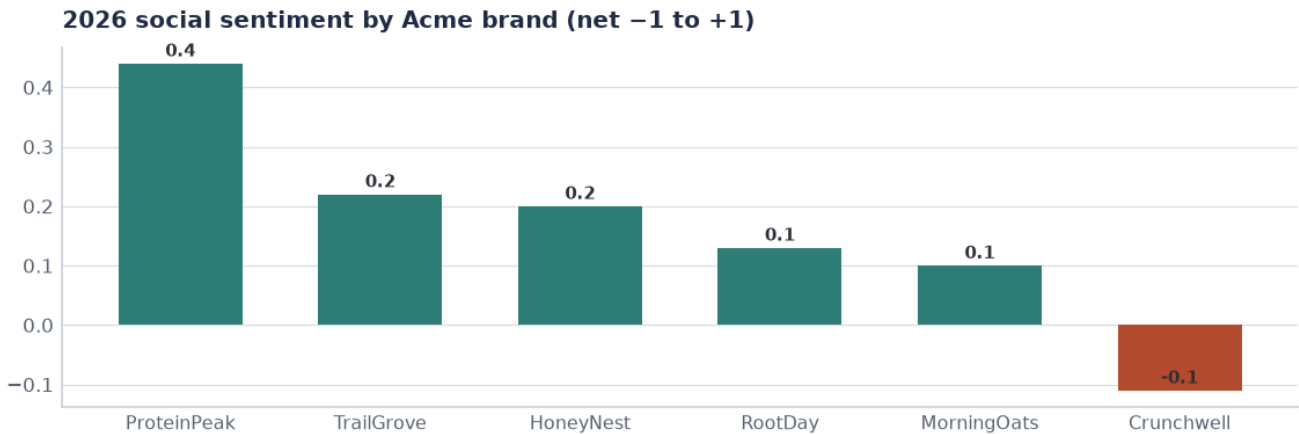
The consumer-health fundamentals confirm this is a relevance problem, not a franchise failure. Crunchwell NPS holds at ~6.5, aided awareness at ~82%, and taste at ~3.6/5 — all flat over two years. Nobody has forgotten Crunchwell and nobody thinks it tastes worse; they are simply choosing brands that feel more relevant to how they eat now. Social sentiment is the sharpest expression of the gap: in 2026 ProteinPeak runs +0.44 across

~496 mentions while Crunchwell is the only Acme brand underwater at -0.11 across 316 mentions.

4.1 · Crunchwell consumer-health fundamentals (FY25–FY26 waves)

Wave	NPS (0–10)	Aided awareness	Taste (1–5)
2025Q1	6.41	81.3%	3.57
2025Q2	6.53	82.5%	3.64
2025Q3	6.44	82.4%	3.57
2025Q4	6.43	81.8%	3.59
2026Q1	6.51	81.8%	3.62
2026Q2	6.54	81.9%	3.57

Source: brand_health, quarterly waves.



ProteinPeak (+0.44) leads; Crunchwell (-0.11) is the only Acme brand with negative net sentiment — the relevance gap in the wild.

Source: social_mentions, Sentiment_-1to1, calendar 2026.

5 · 'Relevance, not Trust' — the thesis

The one thing to take away

Crunchwell does not have a trust problem, a quality problem, or an awareness problem — all three are stable. It has a relevance problem: a -5.9 pp slide on the single attribute that predicts whether a shopper feels the brand is for them, now. The turnaround job (Report 24) is relevance-building — modern formats, culturally-current communications, and the Pack Refresh — not brand repair. Protect the trust equity while it funds the relevance rebuild.

Recommendations & next steps

#	Action	Owner	When
1	Adopt 'relevance, not trust' as the Crunchwell diagnosis; make Relevance top-two-box the tracked North-Star equity metric.	Nina Ortega / Cory Whitman	This wave
2	Direct the Crunchwell turnaround (Report 24) at relevance-building — Pack Refresh, modern formats, culturally-current comms — not product repair.	Crunchwell brand	H2

#	Action	Owner	When
3	Shift marginal A&P; toward the relevance-buying channels (CTV, social, creators) that are working for ProteinPeak (see Report 28).	CMO office / Hugo Lin	H2 planning
4	Re-field the equity wave in FY26Q3 to confirm whether Pack Refresh and comms arrest the relevance slide.	Consumer Insights	FY26Q3